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# THE \$6.6 BILLION GREENLIGHT WINDOW

## The Award Lists to Add to Your Prospecting List — and the Window Where Deals Get Won

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A Special Report from **Hollywood Sales Wire** — the intelligence brief for people who sell into entertainment.

This report comes in two parts. Part One is the method — five short sections, readable in ten minutes. Part Two is the list itself: every project in California’s July 2026 award round, with company names and budget sizes, ready to work today.

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### The one-minute version

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- **The state publishes your prospect list.** California just closed the first year of its expanded Film & TV Tax Credit: 170 projects awarded, \$6.6 billion in direct production spending, nearly 35,000 cast and crew jobs [1]. Every awarded project is named on a public list — productions that have financing and have not spent it yet.
- **The July round alone named 41 productions** — including DreamWorks’ “DONKEY,” Disney’s “Hexed,” a new Pixar

feature, and “Gingerbread Men” from Artists Equity — representing \$1.1 billion in direct California spending about to move [1][2]. The full list is Part Two of this report.

- **There is far more behind it.** Here is how the money works: a state awards a production a tax credit worth 20 to 40 cents on every dollar the production spends in-state — so every credit dollar a state hands out marks roughly three to five dollars of production budget about to be spent with vendors. California will hand out another \$750 million in credits this year, New York \$800 million, New Mexico up to \$160 million, Texas roughly \$150 million from its new fund, and Georgia has no cap at all. Add it up and we estimate more than \$10 billion in production spending will be awarded or activated over the next 12 months (editorial estimate; math shown in Section 4).
- **The window is the whole game.** A production spends its budget in a compressed period between funding and wrap. The vendor who calls inside that window sells into an open budget; the vendor who calls after is displacing an incumbent.
- **Each issue of Hollywood Sales Wire alerts you to new awards and projects as they land** — award-list winners plus the productions that never touch an incentive program, matched against hiring and permit activity — so you are first in line to the decisionmaker.

Every claim below is printed with its receipt. Where a figure is an analyst range or an editorial estimate, it is labeled as one.

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# PART ONE: THE METHOD

## 1. What just happened

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**Key line: California just named 41 funded productions — \$1.1 billion in spending that has not started moving yet.**

On July 7, 2026, the California Film Commission announced the final award round of the expanded program's first year: 41 new film projects, \$1.1 billion in direct California spending, \$187 million in tax credits, 6,198 cast and crew jobs [1][2]. Named projects include DreamWorks Animation's "DONKEY," a second DreamWorks feature, Disney's "Hexed," a new Pixar feature, and "Gingerbread Men" from Artists Equity — the four animated features alone are projected at \$711 million in California economic impact [1].

The seller's detail most coverage skipped: 35 of the 41 are independent productions, 30 of them under \$10 million [2]. Independents buy differently — faster decisions, fewer procurement layers, a line producer who picks vendors in days, not quarters.

Full-year totals for the program's first year: 170 projects, \$6.6 billion in direct spending, 34,921 cast and crew jobs [1].

**Highest-priority move:** turn to Part Two and cross the list against your territory and product line. It is the single highest-yield hour of prospecting available this month.

## 2. Why an award list beats every other lead source

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**Key line: an award marks the only moment when the money is real, unspent, and the buyer is findable.**

A production that wins a tax-credit award is at the one point in its life where three things are simultaneously true:

1. **The money is real.** Award allocation means the financing plan closed. These are not development-stage maybes.
2. **The money is unspent.** Physical production has not started; vendor selection is happening now or within weeks.
3. **The buyer is findable.** Awarded projects staff a production office — a unit production manager, line producer, production supervisor, production accountant. Those are the people who sign vendor orders for cameras, grip and electric, stages, payroll, insurance, catering, transportation, post, and visual effects (VFX).

The usual lead sources miss this moment. Trade announcements cover development deals that may never shoot; permit filings surface after vendor decisions are made. The award list sits exactly in between — and the program design itself compresses the window, because California requires awardees to begin production within a set period or forfeit the credit.

### **3. The lists, state by state — and each one's catch**

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**Key line: California hands you the list; New York and Georgia make you work for it; New Mexico and Texas reward whoever shows up early.**

**California — the gold standard.** A public approved-projects list, updated each award round, naming every project [2]. Program 4.0: \$750 million annual cap, awarded in scheduled rounds — each round a fresh batch of named, funded, unspent productions.

**New York — the biggest pool, the slowest list.** \$800 million annually (\$700 million main plus a \$100 million independent pool), extended through 2036 [3]. The catch: no real-time award

list — project-level reporting arrives one to two years in arrears [3]. The workaround is triangulation: Empire State Development announcements, trade coverage, production-office activity. (Exactly the legwork the wire does for subscribers.)

**Georgia — no cap, no list, different tell.** Uncapped and per-project unlimited: \$11 billion in certified spending across fiscal 2022-24, \$2.3 billion across 245 productions in fiscal 2025 — well off the 2022 peak, which is exactly why Georgia’s sellers need fresher signals, not fewer [4]. No award list — the tell is the Georgia Film Office’s production pipeline. Uncapped means the prospect flow never pauses for an allocation calendar.

**New Mexico — small state, dense signal.** Refundable credit of 25 to 40 percent, capped at \$140 million rising to \$160 million by 2028; productions spending \$327 million in the state this fiscal year [5]. The film office publicizes productions as they register.

**Texas — the new money.** Senate Bill 22 (SB 22) committed \$1.5 billion over ten years to the state’s incentive fund, with uplifts pushing effective rates to 31 percent from September 1, 2026 [6]. New money means new vendor rosters and no entrenched incumbents.

**Highest-priority move:** if your territory touches Texas, get known there before September 1, 2026 — the vendor rosters that form in the fund’s first year will be the incumbents for the decade it runs.

#### **4. The pipeline: what is still to be awarded**

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**Key line: more than \$10 billion in production spending will be awarded or activated over the next 12 months — nearly all of it visible in public pipelines.**

The July California round is one batch from one state. The forward pipeline, with the math shown (figures from program statutes and official announcements; the total is our editorial estimate):

| State      | Annual incentive pool       | Implied production spend                                        |
|------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| California | \$750M cap [2]              | ~\$6B+/yr (year 1 actual: \$6.6B direct spend [1])              |
| New York   | \$800M cap through 2036 [3] | Multi-billion (30–40% credit rates imply \$2B+ qualified spend) |
| Georgia    | Uncapped [4]                | \$2.3B fiscal 2025 (245 productions)                            |
| New Mexico | \$140–160M caps [5]         | \$327M fiscal 2026 actual                                       |
| Texas      | ~\$150M/yr (SB 22) [6]      | New fund; first full cycle 2026–27                              |

Every dollar of it buys from vendors: equipment, stages, payroll, insurance, catering, transport, post, VFX, security, housing, logistics. The award lists are where those dollars first become visible, project by project, name by name.

## 5. Working the window: the playbook

**Key line: the award list tells you which projects; the crew-up listings tell you when to call.**

- 1. Subscribe to the sources.** California’s approved-projects list; Empire State Development releases; the Georgia Film Office pipeline; New Mexico registrations; Texas grants. (Or let the wire consolidate them — that is literally what we do.)
- 2. Cross each new batch against your territory** — state, region, product line. A grip-and-electric house in Atlanta reads the Georgia pipeline; a payroll service reads all five.
- 3. Find the production office, not the studio switchboard.** The buyers are the unit production manager (UPM), line producer, production supervisor, and production accountant.

Industry production listings publish staffing as projects crew up.

4. **Make the funded-money pitch.** “You just got funded. Here is what we do, here is who we have done it for, here is a number.”
  5. **Track the misses.** A project that awarded but has not crewed up in 90 days may be recasting its financing — a second-call lead, not a dead one.
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## What to do this week

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Turn to Part Two, mark the projects in your lane, and find the production office for each before the trades do. The names are in your hands today; the vendor rosters close within months.

And the next list is already coming: California’s year-two rounds, New York’s rolling allocations, Georgia’s uncapped pipeline, and the first Texas grants under the new fund. Each issue of Hollywood Sales Wire alerts you to new awards and projects as they land — including the productions that never appear on any incentive list — matched against hiring and permit activity, so you can be first in line to the decisionmaker while the budget is still open.

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# PART TWO: THE LIST

## The July 2026 California award round — your prospect list

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Here it is: every project posted to the California Film Commission’s public approved-projects table for the July 2026 round (credit allocation date June 22, 2026) [7]. Thirty-eight of the

41 announced projects are posted as of this writing; the remaining three small independents had not yet appeared on the public table (the posted projects account for \$537 million of the round's \$544 million in qualified spend — we print what the state has published, nothing more).

**Read the last column the way a salesperson should: the credit is what the state pays; the production's spending is several times larger.** This round's \$184 million in posted credits sits inside \$1.1 billion in direct California spending — the credits are roughly one-sixth of the money that is about to move.

**The studio slate (6 projects, \$361 million qualified spend):**

| Production                        | Company                       | Qualified spend | Credit       |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------|--------------|
| Untitled Warner Bros. Project     | Warner Bros. Pictures         | \$132,328,000   | \$42,000,000 |
| Untitled Pixar Film               | Pixar                         | \$81,905,000    | \$28,667,000 |
| Donkey                            | DreamWorks Animation          | \$54,725,000    | \$19,154,000 |
| Disney's Hexed                    | Walt Disney Animation Studios | \$47,538,000    | \$16,638,000 |
| Unt. 20th CS Comedy               | Twentieth Century Studios     | \$22,701,000    | \$8,187,000  |
| Unt. DreamWorks Animation Feature | DreamWorks Animation          | \$22,154,000    | \$7,754,000  |

**The independents over \$10 million (5 projects):**

| Production            | Company                    | Qualified spend | Credit      |
|-----------------------|----------------------------|-----------------|-------------|
| Gingerbread Men       | Artists Equity             | \$22,433,000    | \$7,000,000 |
| South Beach           | South Beach Films          | \$20,401,000    | \$7,009,000 |
| DGITHB!               | DGITHB Productions LLC     | \$13,559,000    | \$4,746,000 |
| My Darling California | 2AM-                       | \$11,985,000    | \$4,220,000 |
| Power                 | Star Thrower Entertainment | \$10,188,000    | \$3,566,000 |

**The independents under \$10 million (27 posted):**



| Production                           | Company                    | Qualified spend | Credit      |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------|-------------|
| The Magician                         | Catchlight Studios         | \$8,226,000     | \$2,879,000 |
| I'm With Stupid                      | 2AM-                       | \$7,054,000     | \$2,469,000 |
| Twenty-Seven                         | Bristol Pictures           | \$6,293,000     | \$2,202,000 |
| Breakaway Ray                        | Crossroad Productions      | \$6,236,000     | \$2,450,000 |
| Farewell To Thieves                  | Farewell To Thieves, LLC   | \$5,703,000     | \$1,996,000 |
| The Big Burn                         | Redwire Pictures LLC       | \$5,584,000     | \$1,954,000 |
| How To Make A Movie Star In 9 Months | Cold Iron Pictures LLC     | \$5,501,000     | \$1,926,000 |
| Doll                                 | Jalapeno Goat Inc.         | \$5,137,000     | \$1,798,000 |
| Tony's Money                         | Table 21 Films             | \$5,005,000     | \$2,023,000 |
| Seedless                             | Seedless Movie Co, LLC     | \$4,908,000     | \$1,965,000 |
| Get It Together                      | Film Parliament            | \$4,107,000     | \$1,437,000 |
| Happy Going Nowhere                  | HDN 12345, LLC             | \$4,059,000     | \$1,617,000 |
| The Decline                          | Desperate Pictures, Inc    | \$3,437,000     | \$1,203,000 |
| Show Of Hands                        | Cappadoste Productions Ltd | \$3,188,000     | \$820,000   |
| Shriek                               | Go Rock LLC                | \$2,778,000     | \$972,000   |
| Viv And Vivianne                     | Kowtow Productions Inc     | \$2,322,000     | \$813,000   |
| Life And Limb                        | Suspicious Moon LLC        | \$2,288,000     | \$801,000   |
| Emerald Panthers                     | Emerald Panthers, LLC      | \$2,246,000     | \$910,000   |
| Scum!                                | 1888 Productions, Corp     | \$2,227,000     | \$782,000   |
| Push Don't Shove                     | Fat City                   | \$2,077,000     | \$727,000   |
| Catalina Countdown                   | Forced Perspective         | \$2,062,000     | \$727,000   |
| Nova Six                             | Film 02 LLC                | \$1,721,000     | \$602,000   |
| Carnevil Freakshow                   | CarnEvil Productions       | \$1,387,000     | \$546,000   |

| Production   | Company                         | Qualified spend | Credit    |
|--------------|---------------------------------|-----------------|-----------|
| Glue         | Glue The Film, LLC              | \$1,271,000     | \$445,000 |
| Time Windows | Flashback Pictures              | \$938,000       | \$385,000 |
| Listing      | Wise Lars LLC                   | \$772,000       | \$270,000 |
| Thick        | Tammie's Son<br>Productions LLC | \$686,000       | \$242,000 |

Every row is a funded production that had not started spending when this list was published. The company name is your first search; the production office is your first call.

## If working all this sounds like a bit much — read this

Here is the honest truth about the method in Part One: it works, and it takes discipline. Five state programs on five different calendars, award rounds to catch the week they post, production offices to find before the trades do — every round, without missing one, because the rounds you skip are the windows your competitors work.

That is exactly what the weekly **Hollywood Sales Wire** is for. The wire watches every program, every round, every pipeline — plus the hiring and permit activity that confirms a project is really moving — and lands in your inbox with the new names already flagged. It is, plainly, **your new-leads source**: not a newsletter you read for interest, but a feed you work for revenue.

## How to use the Special Reports and the weekly wire together:

1. **The Special Reports build your machine.** The Spend Map gives you the territory (who has money and which doors it moves through). This report gives you the prospect list (funded projects by name) and the sources it came from. The

Requisition Read gives you the timing (who is buying this week). Read once, set up once.

2. **The weekly wire keeps the machine loaded.** New award rounds, fresh requisition clusters, permit activity — each issue updates your prospecting list with new leads while they are days old, not months.
3. **You make the calls the crowd hasn't thought of yet.** Open the wire, mark the projects in your lane, and contact the decisionmaker — the UPM, the line producer, the production office — while the budget is still open and before the trades tell your competitors it exists.

Run that loop and you own a real competitive advantage that compounds: your prospect list is always current, your calls are always early, and the vendor who is always early becomes the vendor already in place when everyone else finally rings.

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## Method and limits

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Figures in this report come from official state program announcements and statutes (California Governor's Office and Film Commission, Empire State Development, Georgia Film Office, New Mexico Film Office, Texas SB 22), accessed and verified July 2026. Where states do not publish project-level data in real time (New York, Georgia), we say so and describe the workaround rather than implying list parity. The \$10 billion forward-pipeline figure is an editorial estimate assembled from the caps and actuals in Section 4 — it is a sizing aid, not a statute. Award lists identify funded productions; they do not guarantee any production's vendor budget, timeline, or solvency. Economic-impact projections (including California's \$6.6 billion) are the issuing state's own figures and carry the usual promotional gloss; we cite them as the state's numbers, not ours.

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## About Hollywood Sales Wire

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Hollywood Sales Wire is the intelligence brief for people who sell into entertainment. Every issue reads the public record the way a salesperson needs it read: award lists as prospect lists, job requisitions as buying signals, permits as early warnings. The Special Reports show the method; the wire runs it every week — so the next 41 names reach you while the window is still open.

**Hollywood Sales Wire publishes every week.** The Special Reports show the method; the wire runs it for you — new award lists, requisitions, and permits read as buying signals and delivered while the window is still open.

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